Project Pitch

Ecosystem Discovery Application

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ENSE 281

PROJECT IDEA/BACKGROUND

THE PROBLEM

- Environmental education often feels passive and overwhelming
- Learners struggle to connect with ecosystems they've never explored
- Low engagement leads to low retention and low conservation awareness

OUR BELIEF

- People care more when they discover, not when they're just told
- Curiosity-driven learning builds stronger understanding

PRODUCT & OPPORTUNITY

OUR APPROACH

- Interactive exploration of a single ecosystem
- Sticker-book style discovery of animals and resources
- Short, digestible conservation facts

THE PRODUCT

- Ecosystem Educational Discovery Application
- Web-based and easy to access
- Designed for classrooms and independent learners

WHY THIS WORKS

- Encourages curiosity and self-paced learning
- Makes complex systems easier to understand

THE OPPORTUNITY

- Growing demand for engaging digital learning tools
- Fits modern attention spans and learning styles
- Builds early conservation awareness

REASONS

- To educate about conservation and the environment
- To create an engaging interactive experience

IMPACT

- Now, kids learn conservation mostly through passive info (reading/videos)
- Our project will create an interactive, choice-based way to learn conservation through play
- Build early awareness of freshwater wildlife and threats
- Encourage responsible choices (cleaning pollution, sustainable fishing)
- Make conservation of Saskatchewan ecosystems feel local and achievable

WHO?

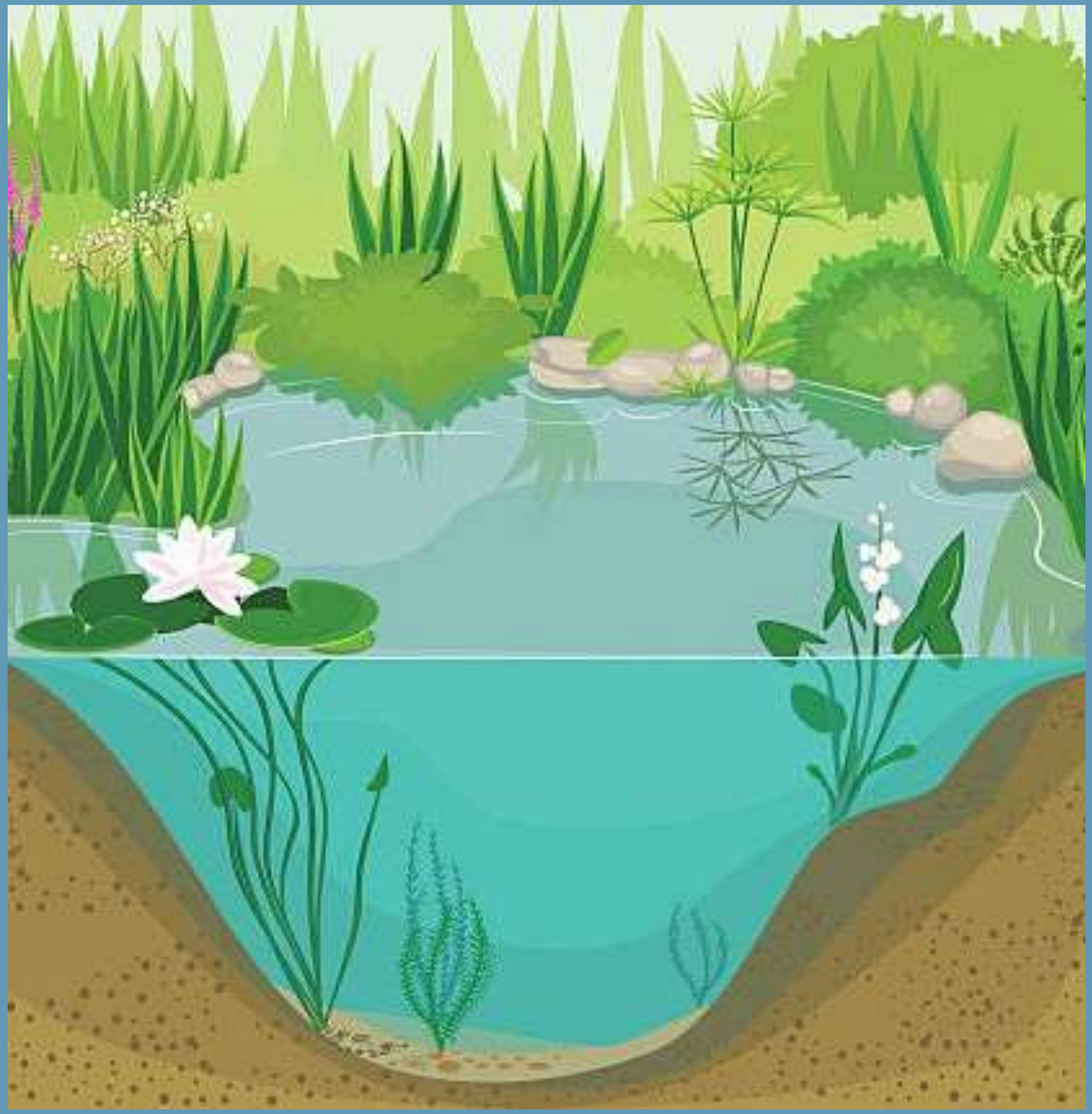
- Elementary-aged children (ages 5-9)
- Primary setting: Saskatchewan classrooms and homes
- Learn through interactive play and exploration
- Collect animals in a sticker book to identify them
- See how choices (cleaning trash, fishing decisions) affect the ecosystem and animal populations

ENVISIONED PROJECT

- Simple 2D Game
- Designed for elementary school aged children
- Teaches about freshwater ecosystems and animal conservation through the act of discovery

ENVISIONED PROJECT

- Background: Section view of a freshwater ecosystem



ENVISIONED PROJECT

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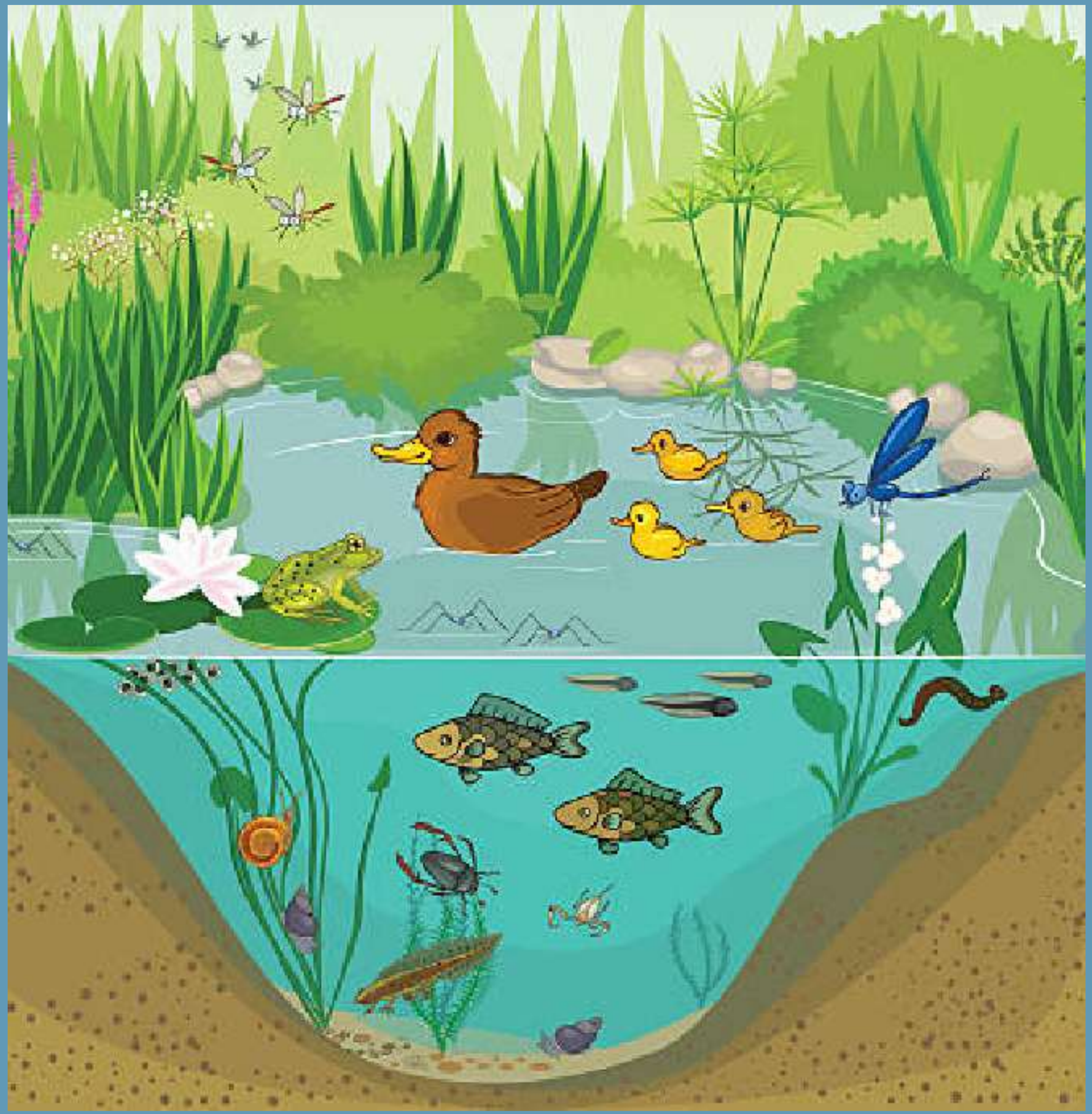
- Events that affect animal populations



CONSTRAINTS AND LIMITATIONS

- Inexperience
  - In creating games
  - In visual art
- Lack a great understanding of freshwater ecosystems
- Knowledge and skills of our audience
- Chosen programming environment
- Model View Controller (MVC) architecture
- Domain-driven design
- Limited time

Thank you!

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IMAGE RESOURCES

- Empty ecosystem: https://www.istockphoto.com/vector/pond-gm491148062-75600195
- Full ecosystem: https://www.istockphoto.com/vector/at-the-pond-gm491135038-75593673
- https://discoverweyburn.com/articles/what-is-regional-kids-first-offering-se-sask-communities
- https://www.istockphoto.com/illustrations/cartoon–of–water–pollution–for–kids